

Wi-Fi Hotspot: Connecting Multiple Devices to the Internet

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Time has come to move beyond wires and USB sockets every time you need access to the Internet. Imagine being able to connect to the Internet from anywhere. With the available Wi-Fi devices, users can check their emails, watch movies, listen to music and a lot more, on the go. They can stay connected at all times and can access multiple Wi-Fi-enabled devices without the additional hassle of investing in separate data plans for each device.

There are usually three ways that can be used to access the Internet on the move and these cater to any mobile Internet needs. The conventional way of connecting to the Internet is by using a SIM card, which is ideal for devices like tablets that have a SIM card slot (for example, iPads). You can go for a SIM-only Internet plan for your device with a SIM card slot and get online to catch up on the latest news, watch films, check emails and more.

The other way of gaining access to the Internet is by using a USB dongle, which plugs into a device like a laptop and allows you to access the Internet. Wireless mobile broadband, also referred to as Mi-Fi, is the

most recent way of connecting to the Internet. It is a pocket-size wireless device that allows you to create your own secure Wi-Fi hotspot, wherever you need to, and connect multiple wireless gadgets at one time. It is simple to set up and use, with no wires or software to install, and allows you to enjoy carefree surfing anywhere, anytime.

Points to consider before buying a hotspot Wi-Fi device

These days every single handheld device has the option to connect to the Internet for staying connected round the clock. Listed here are some key features and their benefits that would enable you to select the right device according to your specific requirement.

Number of devices to be connected. If you want to connect more than one device at a time, you need a hotspot that is capable of managing that. Mobile broadband is a standalone device and allows one connection at a time, but many connected devices can turn into hotspots that allow multiple connections. Most devices allow up to five connections. For instance, Micromax

SOME WI-FI HOTSPOT DEVICES AVAILABLE IN INDIA

	Idea 3G Smart Wi-Fi hub	Micromax MMX440W Wi-Fi hotspot	Vodafone R206 Z	Airtel Quanta QDP1
				
Price	₹ 2999	₹ 2499	₹ 2399	₹ 2300
Features worth looking at	The compact and portable Wi-Fi hub provides 3G connectivity with a press of a button. It provides connectivity for up to ten devices for Internet sharing at one time. It offers HSPA+ speeds of up to 21.6Mbps DL and 11Mbps UL. It also supports WPS and IPV6.	The sleek and stylish Micromax MMX440W Wi-Fi hotspot provides connectivity for up to 32 devices at a single time. The device also acts as a smart power bank with more than 4400mAh of power to keep you connected at all times. It has 4MB RAM and is compatible with HSDPA/HSPA+ network. You can use it as a personal Wi-Fi on the move by simply plugging in the device.	The compact mobile Wi-Fi device lets you connect up to ten devices. You can connect and experience high Internet speeds of up to 21.1Mbps with 3.75 hours of battery life and create Wi-Fi hotspots up to 100 meters. It allows you to store up to 32GB of data in the micro-SD card. The device provides WPS authentication in addition to regular Wi-Fi password based authentication.	With a flick of a finger, this powerful machine creates a personal Wi-Fi zone, anywhere and at any time. It provides seamless 4G connectivity on the go for six continuous hours. It is five times faster than a regular 3G connection. This is truly a one-size-fits-all device and is a powerful gadget that lets you share your Internet with up to ten users. Data speed recorded is up to 61Mbps downlink/18Mbps uplink in 20MHz.

The prices mentioned here are from various e-commerce portals and are subject to change.